There didn't seem to be any problem with money, however. My Army pay, Gertrude's allotment, and twenty dollars a week that her father paid her for working at the Henry Paper Box Company had kept us both going through the Army interval, and the savings account was intact.

There was still more the Army could pay us. Each veteran could get a certain amount of money for his education under something called the "GI Bill of Rights," the exact amount depending on the length of his stay in uniform. It was my intention to refuse to sign up for it on the grounds that I had done my best to stay out of the Army and once in, had done my best to get out of the Army, and that therefore it wasn't just to take money from them.

Everyone else on both sides of the family thought this attitude was quixotic of me and I let myself be talked into it. The deciding push came from the thought that I didn't know how long it would take me to do my research and I didn't want to fail to get my doctorate simply because I ran out of money.

The Army money might make my finances last just those necessary extra months that might make all the difference and with that in mind I let expediency triumph over principle. I do that every once in a while, and I always hate it. I hated it this time.

At least I was spared the discomfort of finding my beloved New York changed. Changed it undoubtedly was, but I was protected from that by my nonvisual tendencies. The only thing that bothered me

about my long absence in Philadelphia was that I had lost touch with the politics of New York City and New York State—and in some ways I never caught up again.

Perhaps worse was that the students in the chemistry department were a new generation and now, at last, I was among the oldest of the students instead of the youngest—an uncomfortable blow.

You can't go home again.

Apartment hunting was interrupted on August 15 with a trip to Philadelphia, of all places.

Henry Blugerman needed paperboard for his company, and paper-board, too, was caught up in general postwar shortages. He knew of a place in Philadelphia where it might be obtained, so Gertrude and I agreed to go there.